

APPENDIX 6

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT AROUND THE WORLD PROJECTS IN NICARAGUA AND CAMEROON



CAMEROON

Canadian Assistance

The Canadian presence in Cameroon stems from a historical interest dating back to 1962 with the opening of the first Canadian embassy on African soil. It was later strengthened when Cameroon joined La Francophonie and the Commonwealth—Canada and Cameroon are among few countries with this double affiliation.

In the early 1960s, Canadian assistance to Cameroon focused on improving the railway and water supply systems, protecting the forests and environment, increasing access to electricity in rural areas, and providing technical education. Since 1993, however, CIDA programs have focused on four main themes to combat poverty:

1. meeting basic human needs;
2. developing the private sector to create jobs and reduce poverty;
3. protecting the forest and environment; and
4. strengthening democratic development, human rights, and good governance.

Bilateral Program

Signed agreements between the governments of Canada and Cameroon provide the basis for CIDA's bilateral assistance program.

Specific projects are delivered through partnerships with Canadian businesses, non-governmental organizations, labour, educational institutions, and all levels of government. Cameroonian counterpart organizations are full partners in all bilateral initiatives. See the Bilateral program page for details.

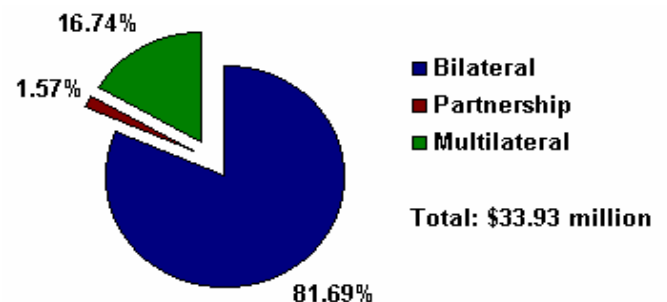
Multilateral Program

Cameroon receives assistance from Canada through CIDA's support of multilateral

organizations like the World Food Programme, the United Nations Development Programme, the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), and the World Bank. In addition to providing funding, CIDA uses its influence within these organizations to improve their leadership and effectiveness in aid coordination, and to promote measures that meet Canada's development priorities. For details, visit CIDA's Multilateral Programs Branch page.

Partnership Program

CIDA's partnership program provides financial support to projects in Cameroon undertaken by Canadian institutions, associations, non-governmental organizations, and private-sector companies involved in development.



Canadian Assistance to Cameroon, 1998-99

CIDA Objectives in Cameroon

CIDA's overarching mandate is to support sustainable development around the world. Its specific policy objectives in Cameroon are to:

1. reduce poverty by meeting basic human needs and promoting good governance;
2. improve the condition of women and promote their participation in political, economic, and social decision-making; and
3. promote the sustainable use and management of natural resources.

NICARAGUA



Canadian Assistance

Canada has been providing development assistance to Nicaragua since 1971. The objective of Canada's current program of cooperation with Nicaragua is to help reduce poverty, support economic revitalization, and provide for basic human needs.

In particular, the bilateral program is focused on supporting the reactivation and transformation of the zones affected by Hurricane Mitch, developing water and energy infrastructure, and providing socio-economic assistance to the poorest people. CIDA is also in the process of programming support for indigenous cooperation, targeting poor regions along the Atlantic coast.

Bilateral Program

CIDA manages a bilateral assistance program involving signed agreements between the governments of Canada and Nicaragua.

Specific projects are delivered through partnerships with Canadian businesses, non-governmental organizations, professional associations, labour, educational institutions, and all levels of government. Nicaraguan counterpart organizations are full partners in all bilateral initiatives.

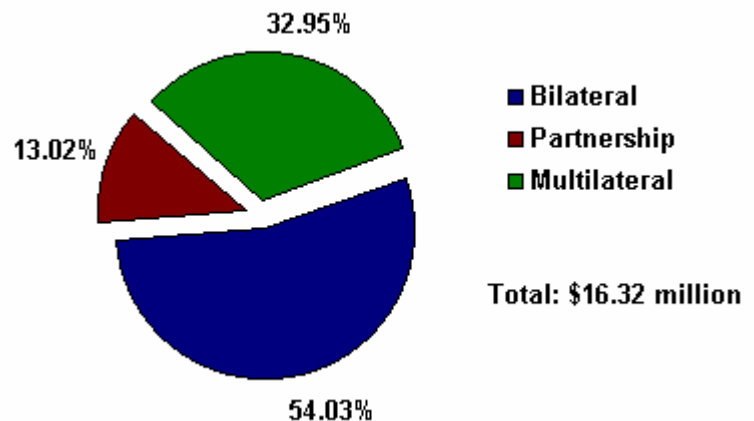
Multilateral Program

Nicaragua receives assistance from Canada through CIDA's support of multilateral organizations like the United Nations Development Programme, the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), the World Bank, and the Inter-American Development Bank. In addition to providing funding, CIDA uses its influence within these

organizations to improve their leadership and effectiveness in aid coordination and to promote measures that are consistent with Canada's development priorities. For details, visit CIDA's Multilateral Programs Branch page.

Partnership Program

CIDA's partnership program provides financial support to projects undertaken in Nicaragua by Canadian institutions, associations, and non-governmental organizations, as well as by private-sector companies involved in development.



Canadian Assistance to Nicaragua, 1998-99



Bamenda Highlands Forest Project, Cameroon

Location

The Bamenda Highlands Forest Project works with forest adjacent communities throughout the Bamenda Highlands in North West Province of Cameroon. Except for the Kilum-Ijim Forest at 20,000ha, which covers the slopes of Mount Oku and the adjacent Ijim Ridge, most of the remaining patches of montane forest in the Bamenda Highlands are quite small (under 500ha). Nevertheless, they are biologically very important and support viable populations of both rare and endangered species, with some plant species being restricted to one or two patches of forest. They are also important culturally and economically providing not only water but other resources, such as building materials.

Project Objectives

The Bamenda Highlands Forest Project works with communities and supporting agencies in the Bamenda Highlands region to assist them to manage their natural forests.

- By the end of the five-year project period (2000 - 2004), we expect at least eight communities to be managing their forests for biodiversity conservation and sustainable use. An additional 10 communities will have started putting in place a management system
- By providing opportunities for "learning-by-doing", the project contributes to developing the capacity of communities, local NGOs and government services so that other communities may undertake conservation initiatives in the future, without external assistance
- The project also works with people throughout the Bamenda Highlands region to develop a constituency that supports nature conservation.

Project Activities

Communities in Cameroon have only recently had the opportunity to gain legal entitlement to forest resources - since the passing of a new Forestry Law in 1994. Although traditional institutions have been involved in forest management and control in the past, many of the institutions have been weakened, and today's social and economic setting presents new challenges.

The project is helping communities to establish community-based institutions for forest management, and to build their capacity for forest management. It is also helping with the legal attribution of community forests - a complex legal process, and is supporting the production of management plans that will generate a sustainable stream of benefits to local people, whilst conserving the important biodiversity of the forests.

Work with NGOs and government services is building the capacity of these agencies to support communities in the process of community forestry in the long term. The project works alongside local staff of the Ministry of the Environment and Forestry when working with communities whilst capacity in NGOs is being developed both by working with them in the field and through internships and seminars.

Communities who have been involved in putting in place a system for forest management will have the skills to repeat the process. NGO and government staff who have worked alongside project staff to help these communities will be able to help other communities in the future.

Environmental education is the means by which the Bamenda Highlands Forest Project is developing a constituency for nature conservation. A range of media is used to inform people about the importance of the forests of the region, such as radio, newspaper, posters and leaflets, displays and public talks, as well as workshops with key target audiences such as teachers.

Field visits to forests to provide hands-on experience are also an important component of the programme¹⁵.

Guaranteeing Quality and Quantity in Ecological Farming in Southeast Nicaragua, Nicaragua

Project Summary

The organizations "Sano and Salvo" (Safe and Sound) and "Primera Asociación Campesina de Cultura and Production Ecológicas en las Regiones Autónomas del Atlántico Sur and Central" (First Farmers Association for Culture and Ecological Production in the South and Central Autonomous Regions) are steering farmers away from the negative impacts of the industrial agriculture of grains and tubers, as well as deforestation and the conversion of forests to pastures. To achieve this, we are utilizing sustainable agriculture adapted to the humid tropics. One of the principal components is biodiversity, sustainable agroforestry using natural associations of flora to imitate the native forested zones of Bluefields, Nueva Guinea and El Rama in the Southern Atlantic Autonomous Region (RAAS) of Nicaragua. We want to live better, improve soil fertility, avoid the need to cut down more trees, and maintain the rivers, forest, and climate, benefiting 20,000 rural farming families of the region. Also, we are seeking sustainable certification to market our healthy products within and outside Nicaragua. We are struggling to maintain ecological quality in our farming and also exporting our products, which are challenges as we must maintain sufficient, steady production to be successful.

Project Objectives

- Utilize the sustainable forestry opportunities in the humid tropics.
- Farm according to international norms for sustainable agriculture.
- Put an end to burning, tree cutting, and soil degradation.
- Sell our products within and outside the nation.
- Become involved in adult education and literacy, emphasizing the role of rural farming families and their importance for the future.
- Maintain control of all project progress by the rural organization.¹⁶

¹⁵ <http://www.birdlife.net/action/ground/bamenda/bamenda4.html>

¹⁶ <http://www.eco-index.org/search/results.cfm?ProjectID=445>